

# The Boston Globe

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## A daily reminder to keep up overdose fight



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF  
Cheryl Juairé has framed photos of her sons Sean Merrill (left) and Corey Merrill, both overdose victims, with the license plate for overdose awareness she's envisioned.

### After losing two sons, woman leads push for license plates

By Chris Serres  
GLOBE STAFF

When her son Sean was battling opioid addiction in early 2021, Cheryl Juairé made him a solemn promise: One day, she would create a special license plate designed to raise greater awareness of the devastating impact of an epidemic of drug overdoses, which has claimed more than 20,000 lives in Massachusetts in the past decade.

"He said, 'Mom, the only thing I want for my birthday are those [license] plates,'" Juairé said. "I promised not to let him down."

Four months later, just after his 43rd birthday, Sean was found dead in a friend's home in

Cape Cod, her second son to die of an overdose. A toxicology report showed he had taken cocaine laced with fentanyl, a powerful synthetic opioid that is lethal even in tiny amounts.

Yet Juairé never forgot the promise she made to her son.

Over the next four years, the Marlborough mother turned her grief into activism, seizing every opportunity to recruit supporters for a new specialty license plate, emblazoned with the words "Overdose Awareness" beneath the letters and numbers, alongside the symbol "OA" and the purple logo of a group that helps grief-stricken families of overdose victims.

OVERDOSES, Page A7

## Many Mass. schools vulnerable to floods

### Located in risky spots as climate keeps warming

By Erin Douglas and Yoohyun Jung  
GLOBE STAFF

QUINCY — When Broad Meadows Middle School got slammed by a powerful nor'easter, the ocean ended up beneath the school, fish ended up in the auditorium, and the city ended up with a \$3.5 million tab for emergency repairs.

"We couldn't even turn on the lights," said Paul Hines, the commissioner of public buildings for Quincy, of the 2018 storm that destroyed the school's boilers and electrical gear. "It was madness."

Data show that the Quincy middle school isn't unique, just unlucky. Hundreds of public schools across Massachusetts are located on flood-prone sites, a Globe analysis of federal flood maps shows, despite guidance from the Massachusetts School Building Authority to avoid building in flood plains.

The analysis identified 342 public school properties where at least part of the site has a 1 percent or greater chance of flooding each year, according to the Federal Emergency Management Agency. Sometimes called a 100-year flood plain, the federal agency considers these areas to be high risk. FEMA's flood maps only represent the most well-known flood-vulnerable areas, meaning the number of at-risk schools in Massachusetts is likely an underestimate.

Nevertheless, FEMA's maps are still broadly and heavily relied upon, particularly for flood insurance and emergency planning.

FLOODING, Page A6

## After deaths, Winthrop shifts response to emergencies

By Jason Laughlin  
GLOBE STAFF

Winthrop is revamping its emergency response services following at least three deaths, including a toddler's, that have been linked to ambulance shortages and overworked emergency crews.

The town is making the changes after a Globe story last month detailed statewide problems with emergency response that have left patients without critically needed care.

Winthrop Fire Chief Scott Wiley and Town Manager Anthony Marino declined to comment, citing the possibility of civil litigation. But earlier in December they released a statement describing changes in how the community prepares for and responds to emergency calls. Those include paramedic training for some firefighters and a reevaluation of how ambulance services prioritize calls for help.

"No one should experience delayed paramedic service in Winthrop or anywhere else due to the unavailability of ambulances or emergency medicine," the town officials said in their joint statement released Dec. 6.

Almost a year ago, Yuna Feeley, a Winthrop 2-year-old, went into cardiac arrest at home. The Fire Department responded to a 911 call from the child's mother, but Action Ambulance, the private company that provides service to Winthrop, didn't have a vehicle available. A backup company didn't have the staff needed to get an ambulance

AMBULANCES, Page A7

## Small businesses fear tariffs would hurt

By Omar Mohammed  
GLOBE STAFF

PROVIDENCE — Todd Nicholson and his partner, Rebecca Ernst, are planning for the future of their three-year-old brewery in Bristol, R.I. But with President-elect Donald Trump proposing to impose tariffs on goods coming into the country from Mexico, Canada, and China, they are worried about how to proceed.

Like many small businesses in New England, Pivotal Brewing Co. relies on some products from other countries. Trump's plan — a 25 percent tariff on goods from Mexico and Canada and a 10 percent tax on imports from China — is intended to encourage big companies to produce goods domestically. But economists say the plan could be detrimental to small businesses, driving up operating costs and making it harder for them to stay afloat.

New England is fueled by small businesses. Approximately 99 percent of companies in Rhode Island, Massachusetts, Maine, New Hampshire, Vermont, and Connecticut have 500 or fewer employees, according to the US Small Business Administration. If small businesses are struggling, the economy of each state in the region could be affected.

"A Walmart or an Amazon, TARIFFS, Page A6

### 'I think it provides an opportunity to bring people to the table that have never been at those tables.'

CINDY NAVA, a onetime Dreamer and now a state senator in New Mexico

## New voices from groups targeted by Trump prepare to speak out

### Recently elected, they bring a different perspective

By Tal Kopan  
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — The first time Donald Trump was elected, Cindy Nava was an activist and so-called Dreamer worried about what his presidency would mean for her and her undocumented family members.

Last year when he won, she was also on the ballot — becoming the first known former recipient of deportation protections in the Deferred Action for Childhood Arrivals program, or DACA, to win elected office.

Trump's return to the White House and hard-line immigration agenda still have her concerned for her undocumented family and friends. But this coming year, she will have a different perch from which she

can represent them, as a state senator in New Mexico.

Nava, 36, a Democrat, is one of several barrier-breaking politicians elected this past fall at the same time as Trump. They will represent constituencies that his policies have targeted in the past, including Muslims and transgender Americans. While they generally won't have direct authority to try to halt Trump's actions, their election offers a platform for new voices to speak out against those actions.

"I think it provides an opportunity to bring people to the table that have never been at those tables," Nava said. "They have been chopped on, they've been discussed on, policies have been made that impact them, but they've never had a seat. . . . And I feel a

NEW VOICES, Page A5

**Five students at Assumption University face criminal charges** for allegedly kidnapping a man they lured through a dating app. **B1.**

**Talks between Israel and Hamas to end the war have made little headway** as the clock runs down on the Biden administration. **A3.**

**A dry January without alcohol can be a challenge,** but many people have found it's worth the effort. **B1.**

**Robert Kraft has big decisions to make** as the Patriots finish the season. **C1.**

## AFTER TRAGEDY, NEW ORLEANS COMES BACK

The city reopened Bourbon Street on Thursday, a day after 14 people were killed by Shamsud-Din Jabbar, and proceeded with the Sugar Bowl at the Superdome (right) after postponing it. An FBI official said it now appears that Jabbar, who posted videos in which he said he wanted the focus to be on the "war between the believers and the disbelievers," acted alone. **A2.**



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## Nothing to ski here

**Friday:** Sunny, breezy. High 36-41. Low 25-30.

**Saturday:** More of the same. High 32-37. Low 23-28.

Sunrise: 7:13 Sunset: 4:24

**Weather and Comics, G6-7. Obituaries, C9.**

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